NO ABBREVIATIONS TO MEMORIZE

AGENTS HAVE A METER

More steps can improve results—and increase cost and risk.

SCAN & LEARN

ONE IDEA

Count model calls, tool calls, elapsed time and failed attempts; set boundaries before running.

VISUAL MODEL

1

COST

Tokens, paid calls and infrastructure

2

DELAY

Waiting, retries and slow tools

3

ERRORS

Bad data, failed calls and loops

Useful result = value − cost − avoidable harm

NOTICE

Budget

Set maximum money, time and tool calls.

UNDERSTAND

Stop rule

Halt or ask a human when progress fails.

REMEMBER

Observe

Measure actual results; never assume savings.

THE MENTAL HOOK

A clever loop without a stop condition is a problem.

THINK WITHOUT A LAPTOP

A search fails 20 times. Should the agent try forever?

ANSWER: No. Apply retry limits and escalate.